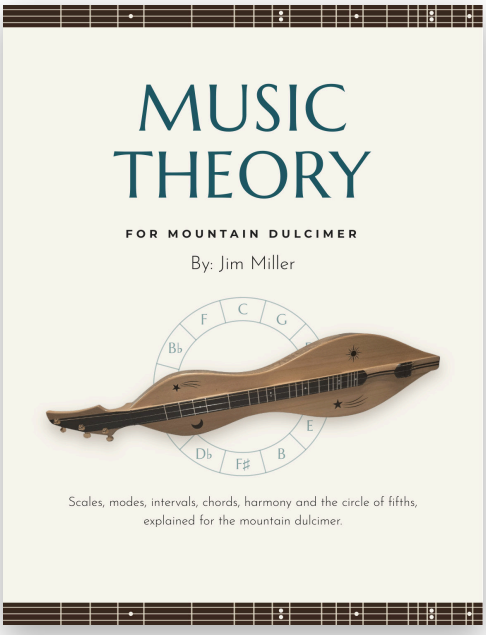
FINGERS OF STEEL® PUBLICATIONS

Music Theory For Mountain Dulcimer

by Jim Miller



Music Theory For Mountain Dulcimer by Jim Miller explains the "why" behind what dulcimer players do.

You'll learn about intervals, scales, modes, chords and their inversions, and harmony, and that understanding will help you play by ear.

19 pages

INSIDE THE BOOK

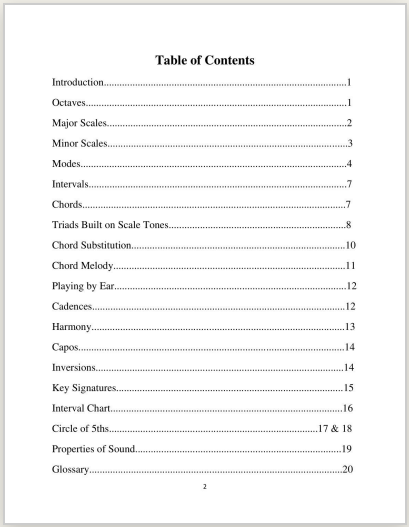
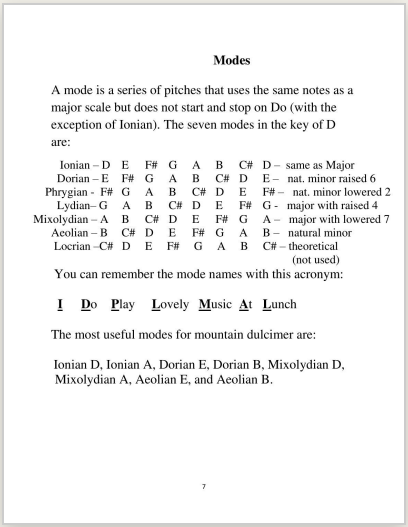


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Modes

A mode is a series of pitches that uses the same notes as a major scale but does not start and stop on Do (with the exception of Ionian). The seven modes in the key of D are:

Ionian – D	E	F#	G	A	B	C#	D – same as Major
Dorian – E	F#	G	A	B	C#	D	E – nat. minor raised 6
Phrygian - F#	G	A	B	C#	D	E	F# – nat. minor lowered 2
Lydian– G	A	B	C#	D	E	F#	G - major with raised 4
Mixolydian – A	B	C#	D	E	F#	G	A – major with lowered 7
Aeolian – B	C#	D	E	F#	G	A	B – natural minor
Locrian –C#	D	E	F#	G	A	B	C# – theoretical (not used)

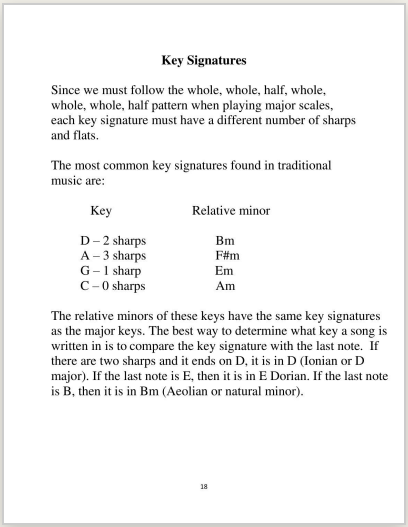
You can remember the mode names with this acronym:

I **D**o **P**lay **L**ovely **M**usic **A**t **L**unch

The most useful modes for mountain dulcimer are:

Ionian D, Ionian A, Dorian E, Dorian B, Mixolydian D, Mixolydian A, Aeolian E, and Aeolian B.

7



Key Signatures

Since we must follow the whole, whole, half, whole, whole, whole, half pattern when playing major scales, each key signature must have a different number of sharps and flats.

The most common key signatures found in traditional music are:

Key	Relative minor
D – 2 sharps	Bm
A – 3 sharps	F#m
G – 1 sharp	Em
C – 0 sharps	Am

The relative minors of these keys have the same key signatures as the major keys. The best way to determine what key a song is written in is to compare the key signature with the last note. If there are two sharps and it ends on D, it is in D (Ionian or D major). If the last note is E, then it is in E Dorian. If the last note is B, then it is in Bm (Aeolian or natural minor).

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